CONTENT

Sr. No. Description

Unit 1: Functional English Grammar—Types of Sentences, Sentence Structure
Unit 2: Functional English Grammar: Transformation and Synthesis of Sentences
Unit 3: Functional English Grammar: Direct and Indirect Speech (Reported Speech)
Unit 4: Functional Grammar: Common Errors
Unit 5: Comprehension from Seen Passages
Unit 6: Comprehension from Unseen Passages
Unit 7: Essay Writing (Short Essays)
Unit 8: Jhumpa Lehiri's Interpreter of Maladies: Detailed Study
Unit 9: Jhumpa Lehiri's Interpreter of Maladies: Discussion on all Important Spheres of the Text Questions
Unit 10: Poetry: John Donne's "The Good Morrow"
Unit 11: Poetry: William Wordsworth's Ode On Intimations of Immortality
Unit 12: Poetry: Nissim Ezekiel's Night of the Scorpion
Unit 13: Vocabulary and Usage: One-Word Substitution
Unit 14: Synonyms and Antonyms
Unit 15: Vocabulary and Usage: Words often Confused and Misused
Unit 16: Vocabulary and Usage: Idioms and Idiomatic Phrases and Their Usages
Unit 17: Explanation of Unseen Passages in Verse
Unit 18: One Act Play: Chitra by Rabindranath Tagore: Background of the Text
Unit 19: Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore: Detailed Study
Unit 20: 'Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore: Characterisation
Unit 21: 'Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore: Theme and Plot Construction
Unit 22: Precis Writing from Seen and Unseen Passages
Unit 23: Jhumpa Lahiri's "This Blessed House": Detailed Study
Unit 24: Jhumpa Lahiri's "This Blessed House": Discussion on All Important Questions

Unit 8: Jhumpa Lehiri's Interpreter of Maladies

Q.1. Why is the book named after the particular story, " Interpreter of Maladies"?

Ans. The characters found in the nine stories of the book all suffer from maladies. Some seek remedy for matters of the heart and others are lost to circumstance. Mr. and Mrs. Das, Shoba and Shukumar and Sanjeev and Twinkle face problems within their respective marriage. Boori Ma and BibiHaldar live on the fringes of society, grasping for hope. Mr. Kapasi, Miranda, Eliot and Mrs. Senstuggle to find their places in the world. Each character is grappling with issues of identity, either directly or indirectly related to the immigrant experience. To some degree, Lahiri herself is the interpreter of maladies, laying bare universal themes of loneliness and isolation.

Q.2. Discuss the significance of Partition as a theme in Interpreter of Maladies.

Ans. Both Mr. Prizada and Boori Ma are victims of the partition. Boori Ma, sweeping steps by day, is uprooted from her home and spends her days cataloguing the misfortunes and losses that arose from her refugee status. Mr. Prizada, teaching on the other side of the world, worries about his wife and daughters who are endangered by the escalation of war in 1971. Boori Ma is exited by the residents of the building because she is a reminder of the possibility of failure in life. Mr. Prizada is accepted by

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Lilia's family in America and Lilia remarks that he is not different. Only an imaginary line has decreed him different.

Q.3 Why does Mrs. Das reveal to Mr. Kapasi that she is not Bobby's father?

Ans. Mrs. Das is looking for a way to alleviate her guilt. She feels a connection with Mr. Kapasi, wrongly assuming that his job as a translator for a doctor gives him healing powers. Mrs. Das wants to believe she can be direction of his disappointing life. Spiritually, Mrs.Das Is removed from the land of her ancestors and seeks comfort in Mr. Kapasi because he represents a life that she cannot know, one of honesty and truth.

Q4 Discuss the immigrant experience as explored in the collection interpreter of Maladies.

All characters in Lahiri's stories are wrestling with identity. Many identity issues arise from the divide between old and new countries, custom, and ways of life. For some, the transition is natural. The narrator of the Third and Final Continent loves his adopted land and decides to grow old in New England. For Mrs. Sen, the separation from Calcutta is too great to bear. Mr. Pirzada and BOORI Ma are both victims of the partition – to varying degrees The lingering questions of identity cause trouble in their lives

Q5 Do you believe boori ma's tales of her luxurious life? Does it matter if she telling the truth?

Boori ma's untrustworthy tales are used as an excuse to cast her out at the end of a real durwan. a victim of partion, boori ma maintains that the riches of her life couldn't be dreamed of by the residents of the building where she sweeps .her ever changing anecdores can be read as either real experiences eroded by memoey or old age , or flat –out lies rold in an effort to protect herself from the harsh realities.

Q6 what does"sexy" mean in the story of the same name?

sexy can mean a lot of different things to different people . it is a subjective feeling .sexy is ,at first ,a compliment paid to Miranda by her married lover , dev . it rings of a maturity that Miranda craves. later , robin , the son of a wronged woman , tells Miranda that the word means loving someone you don't know . his father met a sexy woman on a plane and loves someone other than his mother .for Miranda, the truth behind the childlike definition confirms her guilt and the impending end of the affair.

Q7 food is a recurring motif in lahiri's stories . choose a few examples and discuss their significance

Ans Love is expressed through cooking throughout the collection. Twinkle's meal for sanjeev-prepared on the vinegar he told her to throw our-represent both their butting heads and also her ingenuity. Her use of the unwanted ingredient proves to sanjeev that her point of view is equally valid. That the stew is delicious to put sanjeev at ease about his decision. Mrs. Sen's obsession with fresh fish is an effort to keep Calcutta alive. But also, by denigrating the American product, she use it as an excuse to distance herself form the country. The meals shared by mr. pirzada and lilia's parents reveal their similarities despite the lingering sfferts of partition. The intimacy int the shared meals between shoba and shukumar rekindle their passion andallow them to be honest for the first time in

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

ages, even to the detriment of their marriage .food is a component of femininity in the detriment of bibihaldar. Laxmi's hot mix is deemed too spicy for Miranda.

Unit 9: Jhumpa Lehiri's Interpreter of Maladies:

Q1 lahiri descriptions of the environment often evoke a character's internal state. Choose some example and discus

In interpreter of maladies ,the sun temple is filled with rubble and appears on the bedof a river which has long since dried . this is indicative of the crumbling marriage between mr. and mrs. Das. At the close of mrs. Sen's, eliot assures his mother that he is fine while staring at choppy grey waves, signifying his inner turbulence. The thawing snow at the end of their nights of darkness signify the thawing of communication between shukumar and shoba.

Q2 marriage is representsd in many different ways in interpreter of maladies . what do you think is lahiri's overall vies of marriage?

The Mahler piece that sanjeev listens to encapsulates the many disparate attributes of marriage-happiness, love, struggle and tragedy. Sanjeev's fledgling relationship with twinkle is off to a rocky start because they are so new to one another . shukumar andshoba are torn apart by silence. Communication is viewed askey to a healthy marriage.Arranged marriage, comman in india , have differing result across the stories . mr. kapasi suffers a bad match the narrator of the third and final continent discovers a ture companion in mala. Overall ,there is no clear answer , but lahiri compellingly demonstrates that all. marriages, arranged or not, are unique and dependent on the efforts and communication of the individuals.

Q10 Why is the moon landing so important to Mrs. croft? Why is it so important to the story?

Ans- The third and final continent the narrator measures his time in weeks over the summer of 1969 while awaiting the arrival of his wife.The narrator is new to the country – these weeks are the first six of his life in America .Mrs .croft is an astonishing 103 yearsold.the narrator can barely comprehend what life must have been like the time when she was born.the walk on the moon ,then consideredto be one of the greatest achievements of mankind ,must have been unthinkable in Mrs.croft's time .the events is wonderfultestament to human advancement .That Mrs .croft was able to experience something so major within her lifetime fills her with awe . Likewise, the more mundane but still powerful achievement of the narrator astonishes him.Life is measured in both small steps and leaps and bounds-all to be celebrated. Lahiri sees tolerance as essential both to cultural harmony and within relationship. In this blessed house sanjeev obviously prefers his bachelor existence when he would walk each evening across the bridge and do not consider anyone else in his lonely evenings . He and twinkle are completely mismatched, the prefers an oderly existence while twinkle is lazy, slovenly and careless of convention. because he does not understand her zest for life.

Lahiri shows that in any relationship the two people must be able to learn to tolerate each other's difference . This is even more so in an arranged marriage , where the couple must develop mutual love and respect .Through describing twinkle's taste for christain things . Lahiri implies that sanjeev also must develop a more tolerant attitude toward his new culture if he is to adapt. Successfully . As

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Sanjeev's character shows, the immigrant experience is often painful and the adjustments frequently overwhelming.

Compassion is another value show in Lahiri's stories. Compassion many of Lahiri's stories feature an underlying pattern of human compassion. Shoba and Shukumar eventually develop mutual compassion in 'A Temporary Matter'. Lilia learns compassion through Mr. Prizada's enforced separation from his family. Miranda learns to value herself through her feelings of compassion for the boy Rohin. Eliot feels compassion for Mr. Sen although, in contrast, his mother does not feel.

Q10 Lahiri explores the idea that identify, especially for immigrants, is something that must be sought. We gain a sense of identity through family, society and culture.

Ans. The speaker in ' The Third and Final Continent' (pp.173-98) searches for his identity across continents. He is born in Asia, travels to Europe to study, and finally immigrates to North America. Although he has adapted to the British way of life as a student, it is not a true cultural integration as he lives in a 'house occupied entirely by penniless Bengal bachelors like (himself)'(p.173). He attempts to keep his cultural identity intact by trivial of Indian traditions alive, such as eating ' egg curry'. His search for identity is further straitened by his arranged marriage, to a woman he has never met.

The speaker is burdened with a fragmented sense of identity; constantly pulled i9n opposite directions between Indian culture and the need to assimilate in America. When he meets his centenarian landlady, Mrs. Croft, he is bewildered by her age and her repetitious phrases while admiring her strength in surviving for so long. In contrast with the speaker, his wife Mala is able to maintain her identity because she takes on the role of a traditional Indian wife. The speaker sees only their difference, whereas Mrs. Croft appreciated Mala's grace and charm and calls her " a perfect lady".

Unit 10: Poetry: John Donne's "The Good Morrow"

Q2. What is a critical analysis of John Donne as a poet of love??

Ans love the most felt and discussed emotion of human mind has been a dominnant theme of poems of so many poets john donne has also used love to be an important theme of his poetry since love may be different from man to man time donne has also treated realisically love to be different from one poem to otheres

There are mainly three strands in his love poems .firstly there is the cynical which is anti woman and hostile to the private meeting secondly there is the strand of happy married life, the joy of husbsnd and wife s love these poems are dedicated to the peace and fulfillment to be found in a happy marriage thirdly there is the platonic strand and love is regarded as a holy emotion like the worship of a devotee of god .

Donne s tratment is realistic and not idealistic .he knows the weaknesses of the fiesh the pleasures of and the joy of secret meeting howere he tries to build the relationship between the body and the soul true love does not focus over the body it is the necessary his poemes only t end to emphasize the dichotomy between the claims of the body and need of the soul

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Q3 What is the "seven sleepers den" in the poem Good Morrow by John Donne?

ANS john donne gives some references of physical union like he describes about sewan sleeper sevan slepere is a story of a group of youths who hid inside a cave outside the city of ephesus to escape a persecuttion the forced all his kingdom to worship idolsb and whore rejected he would be killed these men escaped as their faith in god Was strong and refused to worship idols.The SLEEPERS Were Entombed in the cave and were found alive after two centuries

Q4. What are the metaphysical qualities we can see in the poem "Good Morrow?

Ans. The metaphysical conceits present in 'The Good Morrow, in plenty. Donne has compared the transfiguring effect of love and its marcrocosmic Spread with the discoveries of sea discoverers.pre-love days where he was Deprived of true beauty has been compared to "The seven sleepers, so don". in These conceits two very heterogeneous entities have been violently fused in a

Is exactly what metaphysical poetry stands for.these conceits which are far-A certain level of obscurity and novelty of thought which is what the Metaphysical poets strived to attain in their poetry

Q5. How we can discuss the theme of the poem "The Good-Morrow" by John Donne?

Ans .the theme of "The Good –Morrow"by Donne rests with the idea That ture love is a spiritual connection that two people share.Donne Uses many ideas to convey this theme .The most compelling of them Is featured in the second stanza where the speaker suggests that the World shared within the two lovers ,is its own universe,expansive Enough to encompass the world but is only shared by them .in this Setting ,one little room is an everywhere,"indicating that the spiritual The connection between both of them is all encompassing.He sees his Love as two hemispheres that are perfectly blended into one whole . This ture love constitutes both lovers giving all to each other .if this Happens the love between them Will never die.The idea of an Expansive and sprawling and compelling connection is also evident in The comparisons to explorers ,who sail to find new horizons and Vistas ,those shared in the love between the speaker and his beloved . The closing couplet suggests that spiritual connection is not Merel love ,but actually a soulful immersion between two ,a Metaphysical execrise that makes two individuals reside in one entity. In this setting, where ''tow loves can be one," a theme of spiritual residence within the other become the standard and definition of shared and true love.

Chapter-11 Intimations of Immortatlity

Q1. The Pome says a child is a 'Mighty Prophet'. What does a child foretell ?

.A child of six, while enjoying the kisses of his mother and the admiring gaze of his father, already beings to plot out the life he will lead and the events he will take part in-a wedding,a festival, a funeral-and perpares himself for business, love, and strife. He many foresee himself in many roles in imitation of others even down to the time when old age overtakes him

Q2 Give a Critical apprecation of the poem" ode on intimation of immortality"?

Ans- This is one of the most famous poem in english literature by William Wordsworth ˛Originally the poem did not have any title , being creted as Ode Henry Crabb Robinson , a Critic, suggested

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

WordsWorth that there should be a title to the work then writer give it the name. This poem was an inspiration of the poet's personal life. William Wordsworth was a prolific and controversial poet.A major figure in the English Romantic movement , he was know as the optimistic author of numerous lyrical poems, which were written in a simple language dedicated to a daffodil , a daisy or a butterfly , symbols of the splendor of all Matthew Arnold thought Wordsworth;s poetry had "healing powers," educating people to feel again.WordsWoth's Theory of poetry was based on passion and emotions. He believed that even the thoughts rest in feelings. Ode treats the preexistence of human life ,using the poet personal life experience combined with a plotonic concept .wordsworth first mentioned the lasting importance of childhood memories of nature upon the adult mind in ''lines composed a few miles above tin tern abbey ''(1798). In addition to ploto famous theory regarding such memories ,another possible influence on the poet may have been the book silex scintillans (1650,1655) by the welsh born religious poet henry Vaughan.

The main concept of words worth ode is based on the poet belief that the "child is father of the man ''a sentiment taken from jhon Milton paradise regained(1671) and used by wordsworth in his short poem "my heart up '' (Complete poetical works ;1802).in the ode ,he explains that birth is "a sleep and a forgeting ,"not the beginning of life .thus he believes children still carry a glorious memory of the "imperial" heaven as their home with god .innocent babies and children see the beauty of the terrestrial world not only with their physical eyes but also and even more through their hearts and souls which carry a preexisting sense of the spiritual presence .with an elegiac and definitely a nostalgic timbre ,the ode starts with the poet own memory of that blissful place (or state of spirit and mind).

Because of their still recent and fresh memory of the celestial glory, Wordsworth claims, children live in dream–like world of pure joy and fascination. Gradually, while growing, they start to forget. The bliss fades into the light of ordinary day. Their attention becomes selfobsored, less dedicated to solitary thinking and curious questioning. They become physically and mentally involved in various activities, in attending school, and in the distractions of crowds. There are prevalent, pressuring, mundane routines to be learned daily. According to the poet's vision of that stage of life, each individual gradually becomes a "prisoner" and "limitator" of other people and of Conventional ways of life .to fill the nagging of feeling of innate loneliness, a youth blend in, to be accepted into something larger, belong. After the celestial freedom and the previously owned grandeur of peace and harmony the individual is absorbed in a constant search for the lost paradise.

The post laments this loss, but he believes that it is not complete. His acclaimed positivity of outlook is expressed in numerous poems, especially lyrical poetry, and always with a philosophical, sometimes didactic, touch. He combines the ancient, pre-Christian Plato's view with his own Christian-based theory, adding a personal twist. Wordsworth believes there is wisdom in maturity and a different.

Q 4 In Eassy ,compare and contrast Plato's blief in the pre-exixtence of the soul with wordsworth's belief on the same topic ?

Ans. The poem is full of contrasts which serve as a poetical device. Wordsworth speaks of Platonic shadowy recollections which suggest a connection, a continuous existence of the soul, from the part to the present through birth. Another contrast is used between lamentations in the first part and exultation in the latter part of the poem. In the opening stanzas the post laments the loss of celestial heights he possessed in his childhood. In the closing stanzas he exults in strength that he derives from his present recollections of the past. The purpose is to heighten by contrast the victory of soul against its

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

temporary losses, the joy of its permanent possessions. Spiritual life is contrasted to physical life, the heavenly to the earthly. The world is conceived as a prison house which closes up the soul. Earthly pleasures and habits of invitation deepen the prison gloom. But spiritual powers resist the earthly. These powers of the mind remind man that he is a creature moving about in a world of larger compass than this earthly one. They are high instincts that fight successfully the tendencies of our mortal nature. They lead us to that immortal sea that brought us hither. This ode reflects the glorification of childhood, belief in the Immortality of the human soul, transmigration of soul from one World to another and the influence of worldly experiences or Earthly pleasures. It deals philosophically the gradual loss of Innocence, purity and sublimity of childhood and the advance of years..

Q5...What is the view of birth childhood, the child'sRelationship with nature. And the growth into adulthood in Words worth, ode on intimation of immortality? How does the Speaker feels about the past the past how he finds consolation of his brief?

Ans. The poet explains life in his ODE very well. He describe the birth of a child, his
His childhood, the adulthood and the relationship with nature in the life's Various prospects. He states the when we are born ,our souls, which previously Existed in the celestial realm, go to sleep momentarily. When they awake to the
New world around them, the forget almost everything about their heavenly
Existence. But a hint of that existence remains in our souls even though the
World begins to enclose us, like prison walls.
Still a growing child can perceive heavy light. But When a child becomes a man, the light fades and still fathoms of the eternal deep, even as we adults Labor in darkness to discover the truths of eternal realm. Poet call a child 'The mighty prophet' who can foresee his future.

The speaker feels that his past life was better as child, when he was Enjoying nature in its full. He remembers the pest images of nature, earth, Steams, trees, singing of the birds and lambs frolics, in his vision. But as he is Unable to enjoy these natural beauties, he console himself by stating that even Though he is busy in worldly things but still somewhere his visions of childhood has taken a place in his memories ,which give him relief from the burdens of life as an adult..

Chapter 12 NIGHT OF SCORPION BY Nissim Ezekiel

Q1 Consider Nissim Ezekiel as a poet?

Ans; Nissim Ezekiel is acclaimed as the father of post-independence indian-english verse. He is a trend- setter,who started modernity in Indian-english poetry.a horde of contemporary Indian-english poet follow the simple,conversational style of Ezekiel. Not only in the style but also in the selection of themes one finds the influence of Ezekiel in the contemporary Indian-english poets. The major themes of Ezekiel are; love loneliness, lust, creativity and political pomposity, human foibles and the 'kindred clamour ' of urban dissonance. As the poetic muse of Ezekiel flew higher and higher in the course of year, his attitude also changed. The young manwho went after dreams, demanded tryth and lambasted corruption.

Ezekiel wants simplicity of thought and language in modern poetry. He extends the concepts of simplicity to form in poetry. In rhythm, he would aim at 'the natural, the flowing, the direct and the information on conversation. ezekiel become the pioneer of 'new poetry' by his greater varity and depth than any other poet of the post-independence period. Ezekiel brought a sense of discipline, self-criticism and mastery to Indian English poetry. He was the

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

first Indian poet to have such a professional attitude. Under the modernist binfluences he has portrayed a galaxy of themes such as urban- life, fake love life, alienation 'and 'belongingness 'are the most striking issue in the entire bulk of his poetry. Ezekiel is highly optimistic in his poetry. There is no atmosphere of dejection. even though life bis full of sorrows and problem one aspires to live a happy life. His poems show his desire to be away from distraction and obsessions of worldly life; but it is grounded in the physical and social reality. The major concern in his poem is how to live happily , calmly, and ethically as an integrated human being despite having to face so many personal difficulties and depressing moment. 'night of the scorpion ' is one of Ezekiel's poems which is very favourite to the westerners as it reinforces one of their comforting myths about india .

Q.2 Write a critical appreciation of the night of the Scorpion.?

Ans. Night of the scorpion written by NissimEzkiel is an interesting poem and the poet brings about a very appealing contrast between good and evil in it; altogether giving the poem an essence of equality.

The poet makes it a trouble-free task for the readers to visualize the scenes with the appropriate use of various imageries. He has also done a marvelous work of adding various different senses into the poem. All the senses, visual, smell, internal feeling senses vividly with the help of lines like,"…to crawl beneath a sack of rice, "and," Peasantscame like swarm of files."

The poem can be understood at two levels at one level, the poet describes how, on a rainy day his mother is bitten by a scorpion and what are the chain reaction to it. At another level depicts ethos and cultured richness through a simple incident and try to tell us about the typical Indian motherhood which shows sacrifice and affection. The poem thus brings out the mother's love and sacrificial thoughts and the poem thus is very deceptive, as it does not focus on the scorpion at all.

Q3. What are the remarkable features of the poetry of Nissim Ezekiel ,the night of scorpion?

Ans- Is same as **Q2**

CHAPTER-18 Chitra by Rabindranath Tagore

Q.1 Discuss Rabindranath Tagore as a poet.?

Ans. Rabindranath Tagore was Asia's first Noble Prize winner. He was awarded the Noble Prize for literature in 1913 for his book Gitanjali. Although most famed for his poetry, Tagore was a creative genius who played a crucial role in the culture renaissance of India and Bengal in the 19th and early 20th century. As well as being a Seer poet Tagore's achievements included notable contributions in the fields of music, literature, playes, art and education reformer. Rabindranath wrote his first poem at the age of 6 and as a young boy studied the classical poetry of Kalidas. He also studied the Upanishads, languages and modern sciences. In 1878 he travelled to England in hope of becoming a barrister.

However in 1880 he left university college London and returned to india because his father had arranged his marriage to Mrinalini Devil˛Thus Tagore returned home to get married and look after his family estates˛ This enabled productive period of writing poetry , plays and short stories. In 1901

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Tagore moved to santiniketan(West bengal) where he found an ashram , dedicated to returning educational traditions of ancient india˛ Later this school was to be expanded and give the name of santiniketan " Abode of peace" this project was dear to tagore 's heart throught his life.

Tagore poetry was influenced by traditional india poetry ˛ for example , his early poetry was especially influenced by the devotional india poets of Ramprasad and Kabir ˛ Later he was influenced by the Baoul tradition , which is a tradition of traditionl Bengali folk music know for its simply ballads and invocation to union with the beloved.Throughout Tagore work there is strong mystical elements .Although it is worth noting Tagore rarely refered to god directly˛

In 1940 Oxford university arranged a special ceremony in sntiniketan to honor the poet with Doctorate of literature Tagore passed away on 7th August,1941 in his ancestral home in Calcutta the house where he was born.

Q3.write a Critical appreciation of 'Chitra'.

Ans- Chitra is the princess of Manipur. She is brought up as a warrior. When she glances at Arjuna in his ascetic robes for the first time, she becomes conscious of the fact or reality of her being a woman. She considers that she is beautiful enough to win his heart. She woos Arjuna but in vain, for he rejects her on the ground of his vow of celibacy. She does not abandon her love for she is not the kind of woman who nourishes her despair in lonely silence feeding it with nightly tears and covering it with the daily patient smile. In fact, Tagore has pointed out that the flower of her desire refuses to droop before it has been ripened into a fruit. She consequently chooses the easy path of illusion, i.e., the acquired dazzle of beauty bestowed on her by the gods, Madana (god of Love) and Vasanta (god of Spring). In this role she fascinates and wins the heart of Arjuna who kneels down at Chitra's feet and begs for her love. Chitra is fully conscious that her procured beauty would shortly vanish, as the petals fall from an overblown flower, the only moment of her sweet union would slip from her, leaving her ashamed of her exposed poverty, which she will spend weeping day and night. It is impossible for her to keep her disguise and she prefers to accept the hard truth sooner than the false happiness. There is another aspect of Chitra's personality as a terror of evil doers and as father and mother to her people. It lies in the fact of her being a brave girl. She is a man in valour, but all woman in tenderness. Arjuna thinks of her as the goddess of Victory:

Like a watchful lioness she protects the litter at her dugs with a fierce love. Thus before parting from Chitra, Arjuna accepts her in bliss when she casts on him a tranquilizing spell. Chitra becomes all the more beautiful because she has known love, and because she is now a prospective mother.

Unit 19: Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore: Detailed Study

Q1 Explain Tagore's play as a lyrical drama.

Ans Tagore has handled this delicate story with great charm and the play is embedded with sheer poetry. This lyrical drama was written in 1913. It is based on the following story from the MAHABHARATA.

In the course of his wanderings, in fulfilment of a vow of penance. Arjuna came to Manipur. There he saw Chitrangada, the beautiful daughter of Chitravahana, the king of the country. Smitten with her charms, he asked the king for the hand of his daughter in marriage. Chitravahana asked him who he was, and learning that he was Arjuna the Pandava, told him that Prabhanjana, one of his ancestors in the kingly line of Manipur, had long been childless. In order to obtain a heir, he performed severe penances. Pleased with his austerities, the God Shiva gave him this boon, that he and his successors should each have one child. It so happened that the promised child had invariably been a son. He,

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Chitravahana, was the first to have only a daughter—Chitrangada to perpetuate the race. He had therefore, always treated her as a son and had made her his heir. Arjuna promised and took Chitrangada to wife, and lived in the father's capital for three years. When a son was born to them, he embraced her with affection, and taking leave of her and her father, set out again on his travels.

Q2. "Chitra" is a play built and many levels. It is a drama of youth, it is a drama of growth. Explain.
Ans The play 'CHITRA' is Tagore's interpretation of an episode from the MAHABHARATA. Chitra, daughter and only child of the king of Manipur, has been brought up like a boy. She is proud of her prowess and 'manliness' till she falls in love with Arjuna, who spurns her. Broken-hearted, Chitra realises the '*Vain pride of her manlike strength*' and prays to the gods for a brief '*day of perfect beauty*' to ensnare Arjuna. Her wish is granted for a year. But Chitra soon realises that her body had become her enemy, for Arjuna has been attracted by "*borrowed beauty*" and Chitra cannot reveal her true self. The play opens with Chitra meeting Madana. the God of love and Vasanta. the God of Spring.
She tells them that while following a deer along the bank of the river, she has caught sight of a man lying on a bed of leaves. He is no other than Arjuna. She feels instantaneously that she is a woman. She remembers that Arjuna has taken the vow of celibacy. She removes her man's attire and proceeds quickly to meet Arjuna in the temple of Shiva. She begs the God of Spring to grant her one brief day of perfect beauty. Her prayer is granted and Arjuna too, having come under the spell of Madana, is smitten with love for Chitra. But their love is not for a home. She asks Arjuna to take the garland of flowers. She feels tired and appeals to him to take her into his arms. The sound of the prayer bells is heard from the distant villagetemple as twilight approaches.
Their physical enjoyment is full to the brim and they have no regrets. She comes down from the world of dreams, poetry and romance to the world of reality. Arjuna considers her Goddess hidden within a golden image. In spite of her imperfection, he finds in her an incarnation of nobility and grandeur. Arjuna feels that his life is full. (It is fruitful and complete). Chitra feels that she is simply the daughter of a king.

Q3. "Chitra" is a thing of beauty. It presents an evolution of human love from the physical to the spiritual. Elucidate.
Ans Chitra is not a play of action, but a play of feeling, a play of carnival delight and external identity. The central theme of the play is love. It is in this fullness of love in which man and woman share equally that the message of the drama 'Chitra' is contained. The play is marked by a subtle interplay of mood within mood. It is a genuine symbolic play, yielding more meaning at every successive reading. The world of Chitra is the world of mythology and tradition. It is a drama of youth; it is a drama of growth. Tagore represents the symbolism in Chitra—namely the symbolism of the human psyche of youth and growth. He refers to the symbols— "The organic world" of flower and fruit and plant and creature.
There are also the symbols of metaphysical passions of "illusion and reality."' Again he has also stated the symbols of mythological consciousness of Madana and Vasanta and the beloved elves. The whole point of the play is that youth itself is a sudden spring-time miracle, for it comes as it were suddenly and fades away as suddenly, as unaccountably. This lyrical drama is based on the following story of the Mahabharata. She is simply Chitra, the daughter of a king. She is neither a Goddess to be worshipped nor a pitiable object to be brushed aside carelessly. Arjuna will be able to know her real self, if he permits her to be beside him in all dangerous and daring tasks and if he allows her to share duties of his life.
Tagore brings out the message here that woman is not simply a plaything, but a true helpmate and supporter of man. The conclusion of the play with Arjuna's words "Beloved, my life is full", is highly significant and truly relevant. The readers are reminded of the earlier statement that 'Illusion is the first appearance of Truth." Arjuna wakes from the dreary world to the rugged realities.

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Unit 20: 'Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore: Characterisation

Q2. Briefly describe the character sketch of Arjuna.

Ans Arjuna's role in Tagore's play CHITRA is of paramount importance. He does have significant part in the development of the incidents in the play. He is one of the five Pandavas of the "Mahabharata" and he is a reputed warrior. He is known to all as a person well-versed in his skill of archery and has displayed his prowess during and before the war of Mahabharata. His name is closely linked up with Lord Krishna who conveys to him the golden message of the Gita", the lesson of action", at a time when he was lost in despair and disillusionment. In this play 'Chitra', Arjuna is presented in the following situation.

In the course of his wanderings, in fulfilment of a vow of penance, Arjuna comes to Manipur. There he sees Chitrangada, the beautiful daughter of Chitravahana, the king of the country. Smitten with her charms, he asks the king for the hand of his daughter in marriage. Arjuna is of the Kshatriya or "Warrior Caste", and during the action is living as a hermit retired in the forest. Chitra is the daughter of the king of Manipur. Their speeches burn with passion and light up the way from truth to illusion and again from illusion to truth. Arjuna is found fickle. He sees an apparition of beauty in the perfect form of a woman. He thinks that the vague veilings of her body should melt in ecstasy into air as the golden mist of dawn melts from the snowy peak of the eastern hill. Arjuna is enthralled by her beauty when he sees her in the temple. She keeps him completely in the grip of her bodily charms. She has made him her captive. His vow of exile for a period of twelve years dissolves as the moon dissolves the night's vow of chastity. In a mood of infatuation, Arjuna remarks that she alone is perfect. He further states that she is the wealth of the world, the end of all poverty,

the goal of all efforts. Other women can be known slowly, but one single glance at Chitra is to see perfect completeness. Arjuna soon realises that he must go back home. His attention is arrested by the sound of prayer-bells from the village temple, which indicated that he should go back to his normal routine. His mind gets occupied with the thoughts of hunting and longs for the peaceful security of a home. He desires to

possess something that can last longer than pleasure that can endure even through suffering. Thus there is to be seen in Arjuna a transformation from what he is in the beginning and what he is at the end. He is a lover who falls a pray to beauty, but is not blind to the realities. He is awakened to his manly duties to be peformed from his earlier enchantment.

Q3. Chitra is a genuine symbolic play yielding more meaning at every successive reading. Explain.

Ans In *Chitra*, symbolism plays an important role. It is based on the well-known *Mahabharata* story ofChitrangada and Arjuna. *Chitra* essentially contains the history of a development—the development of flower into fruit, of earth into heaven, of matter into spirit. There are two unions in *Chitra*. The first union takes place in the second scene. And the next union takes place in the ninth scene of the play. This play was not meant for dealing with a particular passion but for translating the whole subject from one world to another—to elevate love from the sphere of physical beauty to the eternal heaven of moral beauty.

The central symbol in *Chitra* is the offer of beauty to Chitra by the gods, Madana and Vasanta, for the span of a year. The symbol is not deliberately exhibited, it grows naturally and spontaneously out of the story. Chitra has been brought up as a son by her father. She falls in love with Arjuna, who however does not reciprocate her love. On this being accepted, the action moves on in a poetic-realistic mood, and presents a spectacle of Arjuna's obsession; their living together in perfect bliss; Arjuna's boredom and his longing for the other, real Chitra; the falling off of Chitra's mask of beauty at the end of the year; Arjuna's happy and proud acceptance of the real Chitra and the final spiritual fulfilment. There is no conflict between the surface-realistic level and the deeper symbolic meaning. The symbolic meaning is related to the

essential duality of life, which in the story expresses itself as the duality of love. There is no contradiction between Infinite and Finite, Truth and Illusion, Spirit and Body, Love and Desire, joy

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

and Pain, Peace and Restlessness, True self and False self, but what is most remarkable in the play is that the latter i.e., Finite, Illusion, Body, Desire, Pain, Restlessness, False self are transmitted into the former i.e., Infinite,
Truth, Spirit, Love, Joy, Peace, and True self. In short, Chitra stands for human desire; Arjuna stands as the seeker of love; the gods Madana and Vasanta stand for love and youth and beauty respectively.
The symbols in *Chitra* are an organic part of the theme. *Chitra* combines the flowers of spring with the fruits of autumn. It also combines heaven and earth. Truly, in *Chitra* there is one Paradise Lost and another Paradise Regained.

Unit 21: 'Chitra' by Rabindranath Tagore:

Theme and Plot Construction

Q1. What is the plot construction of Chitra? Discuss.
Ans *Chitra* is a play in one act and nine scenes. *Chitra* also consists of the exposition, the initial incident, its development, crisis, falling action and catastrophe. In the first scene, there is the rebuff of Chitra by Arjuna. Chitra tells Madana (god of Love) and Vasanta (god of Youth and Beauty) how, on seeing Arjuna, she had broken her bow and cast away her arrows, changed her boy's attire to a woman's, and approached him—only to be rejected, because of his vow of celibacy. While she knows there is a
long hard way of winning him, she contemplates to take recourse to an easy way by asking for the gift of physical beauty from the gods. She then acquires it for the span of a whole year. The machinery of the gods constitutes an integral part of the plot of action. The gods granted her prayer of being endowed with beauty and extraordinary charms for a year.
The playwright thus prepares a background of passion, love, romance and beauty in the very beginning against which the action here would develop. In the second scene, there is the spurning of Arjuna by Chitra The story develops with Arjuna's sudden acceptance of Chitra later on, due to Chitra having been endowed with beauty and grace for a year by the gods of Love and Spring. The triumph of the body over the soul is revealed here. Chitra is falsehood, an illusion, a deceit of a god. Chitra admits this to Arjuna and reveals to him In the third scene, one sees the physical union of Chitra and Arjuna. Then Chitra tells Madana and Vasanta that during the previous night Arjuna had come and made love to her. Yet she is full of remorse because Arjuna had not loved her but only her borrowed beauty. Her body has thus become her own enemy.
Chitra and Arjuna's union does not give Chitra a sense of satisfaction, but on the contrary it brings out the dormant anguish of her soul. Her physical beauty is a temporary one. obliquely her true identity. But to Arjuna everything seems to be a dream; he forgets his vow of celibacy and perceives the appearance of beauty which is now before him. Behind this is concealed a cry of agony. The two gods appear for the second time in the scene. It is through Chitra's dialogue with them that the action the drama is further unfolded and the symbolic meaning of the play is revealed that, Man is not content with the earthly bliss (which is temporal) and he essentially longs for a bliss, which is of a higher type (which is permanent). The entire atmosphere in the scene is romantic and passionate The language used is also romantic and poetic. In the fourth scene, the decline of Arjuna's passion is described. As the days pass, there is a sharp decline in Arjuna's zeal. It is difficult to say whether it is Chitra that is giving Arjuna eyes to see that mundane unfolding truth, or whether she is too self conscious, The fifth scene is an Interlude. The fervour of Vasanta. (Youth and Beauty) cannot keep pace with the demands of Madana (Love). There is the inevitable awakening of spring, as it draws to a close. In the sixth scene, further decline of Arjuna's obsession is depicted. Arjuna who readily switched over from asceticism to love now longs for the old days when he used to hunt with his brothers. Contemplation entangles, and he wonders about his companion, her home and parents. The seventh scene witnesses another interlude. Madana grants Chitra's wish that her beauty shall flash brightest on the last night of Spring. The playwright wants to suggest that the spirit of beauty is
eternal. It never dies. It only changes shapes. Similarly the beauty of the spirit is also eternal.

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

In the eighth scene, the real Chitra comes to light. Arjuna hears from wandering villagers about the princess Chitra now gone on a journey. So he ponders about the real Chitra, whose arms with beauty of strength is a fright to the robbers. The ninth scene leads us from falsehood to truth. Chitra returns to Arjuna as she had been when she first met Arjuna. Yet she is not quite the same, for she is also the prospective mother of Arjuna's son. Arjuna is satisfied, and has a sense of complete fulfilment and even Chitra has no remorse.
Thus, Chitra reveals herself to Arjuna in this scene and reminds him of her first meeting with him.
She clarifies that woman is a helpmate of man and is not merely his plaything. This is what Tagore has visualized in the character of Chitra. Arjuna and Chitra fully wake to reality at the end of the play.

Q2. Discuss the theme in the plan 'Chitra'.
Ans *Chitra* exhibits a realization of the diviner elements of life and love; a heavenly message to the human soul as to what is the meaning of love in the truest sense of the term. In *Chitra,* Tagore discusses the evolution of human love from the physical to the spiritual. In the last scene Chitra tells Arjuna: Chitra makes her last sacrifice at Arjuna's feet. She brings from the garland of heaven the flowers of incomparable beauty to worship him. She is not as perfect as the flowers with which she worships
him. She brings to him the gift of a heart of a woman, which is full of pains and pleasures, the hopes and fears and shames of a daughter of the dust. The imperfection, inspite of what it is, is noble and grand. Further, the physical relationship between man and woman is the foundation of love, its composition is provided by their spiritual relationship. Love will find its fruition only when the mind and the heart of the lover and the beloved are completely united. This theme of transcendent love in *Chitra* is
best explained through suggestion, which is the keynote of dramatic art. So Tagore instead of evidently telling so many things in so many words, merely suggests by way of symbols and images. In *Chitra* the central symbol is the offer of beauty to Chitra by the gods. She desires to win the love of Arjuna in a short span.

The play In *Chitra* he deals with the theme of human love that goes beyond its physical limitations in order to realize its full significance. The merger of man and woman is the marriage of true minds, an entire compass ranging from the sensual to the spiritual. Tagore is a true child of his great poetic ancestors. He has recognized and expressed the true glory of love in his works.conveys the message of the fullness of love. The remarks that Tagore has made in respect to Kalidasa hold true for the poet himself. Moreover Krishna Kriplani also opines that "the play is very characteristic of the author. It represents a basic and permanent attitude of his mind and philosophy—his unification of man and nature, the latter almost an active participant in the drama of life and his concern with the perennial question, what is beauty; what is love; what is the true and enduring basis of man-woman relationship?"

Q3. What conflict and soliloquy do you see in Chitra? Discuss.
Ans Conflict is the soul of a drama. It is the datum and very backbone of a dramatic story. "The dramatic action develops as a result of the conflict—some clash of opposed individuals, or passions, or interest."

The conflict may be external or internal. *Chitra* has both the kinds of conflict—external and internal.
For instance, the external conflict is visible in the beginning of the play, when Arjuna does not pay attention to the suit of the love of Chitra on the plea that he was in exile and that the vow of celibacy forbade him to respond to the beauty and charms of a lady. It is with this external conflict that the play starts. Then Chitra in her conversation with Madana tells him to teach her his lessons; give her the power of the weak and the weapon of the unarmed hand.

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

There is an internal conflict too, which is always there in Chitra's mind when she entices Arjuna by the charms and graces bestowed on her by the gods. She is fully aware of the fact that the gods have granted to her this beauty for a year only and therefore she decides that after the end of the period when she would appear in her real self before Arjuna, she would then eventually repulse him. She therefore enjoys the period granted with fullness, but thinks continuously that Arjuna does not love her. It is her borrowed beauty that is loved by him. This inward conflict becomes pronounced when she ultimately decides that before the expiry of the period of one year she would tell Arjuna all the facts and thus lift the heavy burden off her mind by this act of penitence. Otherwise, her dream to clasp Arjuna shall get shattered.

Soliloquy: Soliloquy is the dramatist's means of taking us down into the hidden labyrinths of a person's nature, and of revealing those springs of conduct which ordinary dialogue provides him with no adequate opportunity to disclose.
Tagore has used the device of soliloquy in *Chitra* and thereby has turned it into an appealing and effective play. The soliloquies reveal the minds of his characters. Arjuna speaks two soliloquies, while Chitra has only 'one in the entire play. Further, it is well known that soliloquies are an integral part of the form of drama and hence (as exemplified by these illustrations) its inclusion in *Chitra* as an effective dramatic medium justifies the play as being categorized as a play with lyrical qualities.

Q4. Explain intensity of emotion and lyrical quantity.

Ans It is well known that soliloquies are an integral part of the form of drama and hence (as exemplified by these illustrations) its inclusion in *Chitra* as an effective dramatic medium justifies the play as being categorized as a play with lyrical qualities.

Unit 23: Jhumpa Lahiri's "This Blessed House": Detailed Study

Q1. Why do people admire Twinkle?
Ans "This Blessed House" is set in present-day Connecticut. A young Indian couple, Sanjeev and Twinkle, are recently married and have just moved into their new house. As they go about investigating and fixing up the house, they begin to find small Christian knickknacks, left behind by the previous owners. Twinkle first finds a porcelain effigy of Christ. Sanjeev does not like it and tells Twinkle to get rid of it, but she thinks it is pretty and might even be worth something.
Sanjeev reminds her that they are not Christians. No, she confirms, they are Hindus. She puts the statue of Christ on the fireplace mantel.

Over the next few days, more Christian items turn up: a 3-D postcard of Saint Francis, which had been taped to the back of a medicine cabinet; a wooden cross key chain; a framed paint-by number painting of the three wise men, which had been hiding in a linen closet; a tile trivet showing Jesus delivering a sermon on a mountaintop; and a snow-filled dome containing a miniature Nativity scene. Twinkle arranges them all on the mantel. Sanjeev thinks they are all silly and wonders why Twinkle is so charmed by them. He wants her to throw them all away, but Twinkle says it would feel sacrilegious to do so. She hopes to find more.

Q2. What do you think Sanjeev and Twinkle's relationship, is the true love like he thought?
Ans Sanjeev is a thirty-three-year-old Indian immigrant to the United States, married to Twinkle. His parents still live in India. Sanjeev is a successful man, with an engineering degree from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). After graduating, he moved from Boston to Connecticut to work for a firm near Hartford. He excels at his work, in which he supervises a an attempt to fix every small imperfection. Sanjeev keeps his life as orderly and precise as possible. He tries to control his life by controlling the things.

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Q3. Why is Twinkle charmed Christ, but Sanjeev against it?
Ans "This Blessed House" is set in present-day Connecticut. A young Indian couple, Sanjeev and Twinkle, are recently married and have just moved into their new house. As they go about investigating and fixing up the house, they begin to find small Christian knickknacks, left behind by the previous owners. Twinkle first finds a porcelain effigy of Christ. Sanjeev does not like it and tells Twinkle to get rid of it, but she thinks it is pretty and might even be worth something.
Sanjeev reminds her that they are not Christians. No, she confirms, they are Hindus. She puts the statue of Christ on the fireplace mantel. Over the next few days, more Christian items turn up: a 3-D postcard of Saint Francis, whichhad been taped to the back of a medicine cabinet; a wooden cross key chain; a framed paint-by number painting of the three wise men, which had been hiding in a linen closet; a tile trivet showing Jesus delivering a sermon on a mountaintop; and a snow-filled dome containing a miniature Nativity scene. Twinkle arranges them all on the mantel. Sanjeev thinks they are all
silly and wonders why Twinkle is so charmed by them. He wants her to throw them all away, but Twinkle says it would feel sacrilegious to do so. She hopes to find more.
A week later, Twinkle finds a watercolor poster of Christ, weeping and with a crown of thorns on his head. She wants to display it, but Sanjeev refuses. Twinkle says she will put it in her study, so he will not have to look at it.
When Sanjeev has a moment to himself, he recalls a dinner he and Twinkle had in Manhattan a couple of days before. Twinkle drank four glasses of whiskey in a bar, then dragged him into in a bookstore for an hour, and then insisted that they dance a tango on the sidewalk.
A few days later, Sanjeev returns from the office to find Twinkle on the phone to her girlfriend in California, talking enthusiastically about the "Christian paraphernalia." Each day is like a treasure hunt, she says. As Sanjeev observes her, he is aware that certain things about her irritate him. The way she sometimes spits a little as she speaks, for example. They have not yet been married two months, and they only met four months before. The meeting, which took place in Palo Alto, California, had been arranged by their parents. Twinkle's parents live in California, and Sanjeev's parents live in Calcutta, India. They married in India after a brief long-distance courtship punctuated by weekends together.

Unit 24: Jhumpa Lahiri's "This Blessed House":

Q1. What is the reader's initial impression of Twinkle?
Ans Twinkle is a very pretty, young Indian woman, who likes to get dressed up and look good. Her face was very girlish looking and had untroubled eyes. Her name in itself shows shw's a fun girl. In the story it states she loved to wear high heels, some that were three inches and leopard print. This shows that she's fun and likes to be seen. It also said that she wore someblack stirrup pants and a yellow chenille sweater. So she can still look cute dressing down too. It also says that she had an appointment for a manicure and pedicure before the party so she doesn't like to just dress good, but look good all the way around What she wears to the party is also described as very elegant and classy, but fun at the same time. Twinkle definitely has a sense of style. Twinkle also did not have the same taste in music as Sanjeev did because when he was listening to his music she told him to turn it off because it was putting her to sleep. Twinkle also proved that she doesn't care what people think by constantly asking Sanjeev why he always cares what people think because clearly she doesn't care. I also noticed that Twinkle is very outgoing and definitely a people person. She knows how to start a conversation and to keep guests entertained with different stories she would tell and what not. It is go. Twinkle also likes to tease Sanjeev. It is noticed this by the way she carried herself the times when she would squeeze his leg or his arm. She likes to read when she's bored, but also talk to her girlfriends on the phone. I think this shows she's easily entertained. She's also very carefree because she leaves clothes at the front of her closed, would read whatever magazine, and listen to whatever song on the radio. She gets excited by the tittle things in life. Like when Sanjeev always refilled her glass when

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

they would go out together. As fun loving and carefree as she is though, she likes to read thinkgs like Sonnets and German films and was getting her masters degree. So Twinkle was also very intelligent.

Even though she was not the greatest in the kitchen, she came up with a dish on her own and it even tasted good. This shows she's creative too. I also think that Twinkle liked to keep her emotions to her since she cried once in the story and that was the only time Sanjeev had ever seen her cry. I don't think she was crying just because of statue, but it had built up and that was the final straw. Twinkle also shows leadership. She took it upon herself to entertain the guests and get them interested in something they probably wouldn't normally be interested in. But by her enthusiasm she got them excited and they followed her wherever she went. assume her smoking was a way of just letting her troubles

Q2. The relics "meant something to Twinkle" but nothing to Sanjeev. Explain their different views.

Ans In the story, a young Indian couple, Sanjeev and Twinkle, have just married and have begun to settle into their newly purchased Connecticut home. As they clean and unpack, they begin to find devotional trinkets left by the Christians who sold the house. Little porcelain effigies, gospelthemed snow globes, and posters and postcards of saints litter the house. Twinkle decides to display the kitschy knickknacks around their home; Sanjeev, more traditional and socially self-conscious about his Indian roots, protests. Gradually the story reveals that Twinkle and Sanjeev's differences run deeper than their preferences about what sits on the mantel.

Sanjeev grew up in India, attended MIT, and approaches his work with a seriousness that manifests an anxiety for his peers' opinions of him. Twinkle was raised in California and approaches life with an uncalculated levity that makes her fun but also shallow, spontaneous, and insincere. They quarrel as Twinkle's boredom with her new life provokes Sanjeev to frustration. In the story's final scene, Twinkle gushes about her kitsch discoveries to some dinner guests. To Sanjeev's discomfort, the story incites a group treasure hunt around the house to look for more of the kitsch. As a dinner guest emerges from the attic with a large silver bust of Jesus, Sanjeev's discomfort dissolves into bland resignation.

Q3. How did Sanjeev and Twinkle meet and why did they marry after only knowing each other for four months?

Ans They had met only four months before. Her parents who lived in California, and his who still lived in Calcutta, were old friends, and across continents they had arranged the occasion at which Twinkle and Sanjeev were introduced — a sixteenth birthday party for a daughter in their circle — when Sanjeev was in Palo Alto on business. At the restaurant they were seated side by side at a round table with a revolving platter of spareribs and egg rolls and chicken wings, which, they concurred, all tasted the same. They had concurred too on their adolescent but still persistent fondness for Wodehouse novels, and their dislike for the sitar, and later Twinkle confessed that she was charmed by the way Sanjeev had dutifully refilled her teacup during their conversation. And so the phone calls began, and grew longer, and then the visits, first he to Stanford, then she to Connecticut, after which Sanjeev would save in an ashtray left on the balcony the crushed cigarettes she had smoked during the weekend — saved them, that is, until the next time she came to visit him, and then he vacuumed the apartment, washed the sheets, even dusted the plant leaves in her honor.

She was twenty-seven and recently abandoned, he had gathered, by an American who had tried and failed to be an actor; Sanjeev was lonely, with an excessively generous income for a single man, andhad never been in love. At the urging of their matchmakers, they married in India.

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.

Q4. Explain the dynamics of the house warming party.

Ans They are preparing for a housewarming party at the end of October, to which they have invited thirty people, all of them Sanjeev's acquaintances. Twinkle, who is still a student at Stanford University, knows no one in the area. The weekend before the party, Twinkle finds a plaster Virgin Mary in the yard, behind an overgrown bush. Twinkle wants to keep it but Sanjeev says the neighbors will think they are insane. As they argue about it, Sanjeev begins to realize that he does not know Twinkle very well, and he is not sure whether he loves her. Nor is he sure that she loves him. That evening, when Twinkle is lying in a bubble bath, Sanjeev says he is going to remove the
statue of the Virgin from the front lawn and take it to the dump. Twinkle stands up and says she hates him. She gets out of the bath, wraps a towel around her waist, and follows him down the staircase. She says she will not let him throw the statue away. He notices that she is crying, and his heart softens. They agree on a compromise. The statue will be placed in a recess at the side of the house so passersby will not see it, although it will still be visible to anyone who comes to the house. They make extensive preparations for the party, cooking and cleaning. The first guests to arrive are Douglas and Nora. Having seen the statue of the Virgin, Douglas inquires whether Sanjeev and Twinkle are Christians. Sanjeev replies that they are not. Soon all the guests have arrived. Everyone is elegantly dressed. They congratulate Sanjeev and admire the house. They admire Twinkle even more, and gather around her, laughing at her anecdotes and observations. Twinkle takes them on a tour of the house, and she tells Sanjeev that they all loved the poster of Christ in the study. After Twinkle explains about how they found all the Christian items, everyone starts to search around the house to see if they can find any more. They climb up a ladder to get to the attic,
although Sanjeev has no desire to join them. He hears a shriek, followed by waves of laughter.

When Twinkle descends from the attic, she is carrying a large silver bust of Christ. Sanjeev takes it from her and finds it is heavy, weighing about thirty pounds. Twinkle asks if she can display it on the mantel just for the evening. After that, she says, she will keep it in her study. But Sanjeev knows this will never happen. Twinkle will keep the bust of Christ on the center of the mantel along with all the other items he dislikes. But he does not argue with her. Instead, he follows her into the living room, carrying the statue.

********** END OF NOTES **********

An evaluation version of novaPDF was used to create this PDF file.
Purchase a license to generate PDF files without this notice.